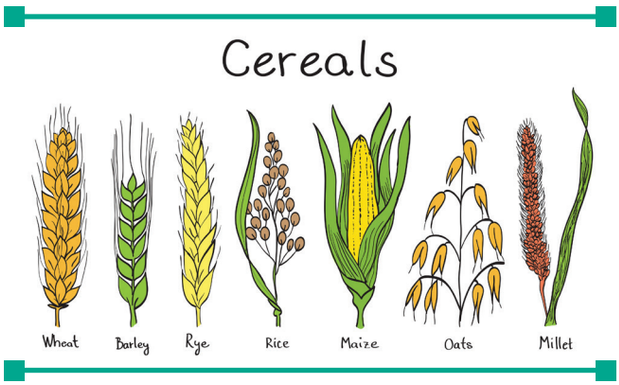



▲ Cereals




▲ Oil seeds



▲ Egg



▲ Oil



▲ Pulses



▲ Milk

## 5.3 MICRONUTRIENTS

Until the middle of the 19th century the importance of minerals and vitamins was not given adequate emphasis. It was observed that the macronutrients alone were not sufficient to promote and sustain growth.

This led to the discovery of the micronutrients namely the minerals and vitamins which are essential for growth and maintenance. Macro minerals are those which are present at levels more than 0.05 percent in the human body. Calcium, phosphorus, magnesium, sodium and potassium belong to this category. Other minerals present at less than 0.05 percent in the human body are defined as micro minerals. The micro minerals are also



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